

Phishing Detection & Awareness

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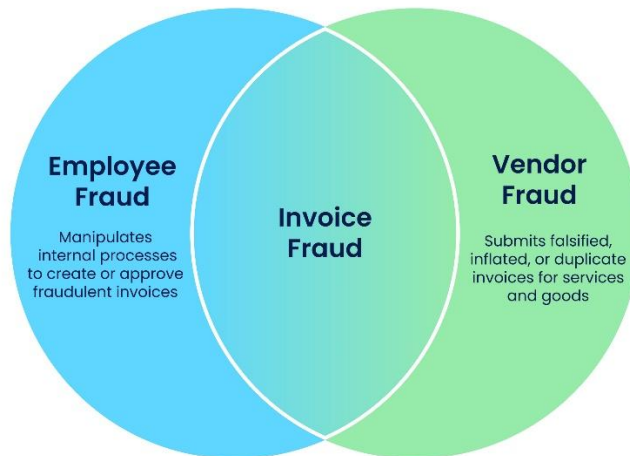
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Detailed Phishing Email Examples

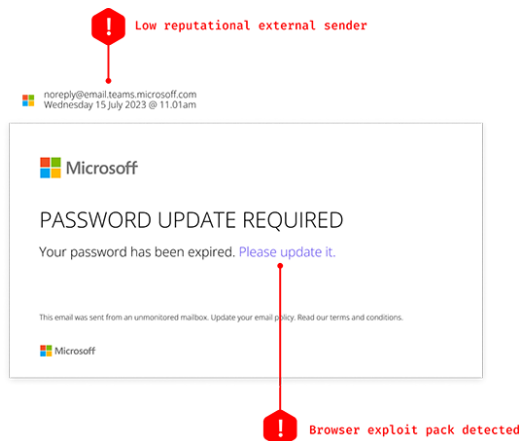
- Fake Vendor Invoice (Google & Facebook case)

Attackers impersonated a legitimate hardware vendor and sent fake invoices. Even large corporations paid out over \$100 million before realizing the fraud. This shows how convincing phishing can be, even for experts.



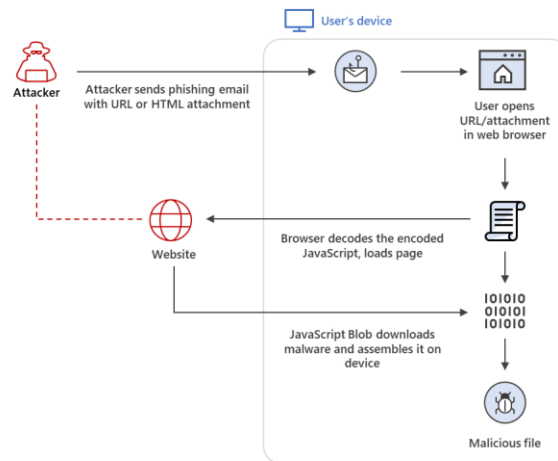
- Credential Harvesting Email

A message claiming “Your Office 365 account will be disabled unless you verify.” The link led to a fake login page that captured usernames and passwords.



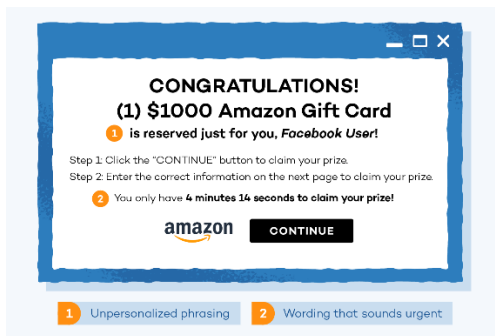
- Malware Delivery via Attachment

Email disguised as a “shipping receipt” with a Word document attachment. Opening it triggered macros that installed malware.



- **Prize Scam**

“You’ve won a \$500 Amazon gift card!” Clicking the link redirected to a malicious site that requested personal details.



Common Phishing Indicators

- **Domain Spoofing:** Attackers register lookalike domains (e.g., micros0ft.com).
- **Urgency & Fear:** “Your account will be locked in 24 hours.”
- **Unexpected Attachments:** Files disguised as invoices or receipts.
- **Generic Greetings:** “Dear Customer” instead of personalized names.
- **Grammar Errors:** Typos and awkward phrasing.
- **Too-Good-To-Be-True Offers:** Free prizes or rewards.

Risk Classification

Email Type	Risk Level	Impact
Fake Vendor Invoice	High	Direct financial loss (millions possible)
Credential Harvesting	High	Compromise of accounts, data breaches.

Malware via Attachment	High	System infection, ransomware, data theft.
Urgent Account Suspension	Medium	Loss of credentials, account hijacking.
Prize Scam	Medium	Identity theft, malware installation.

Simple Explanation of Attacks

Phishing emails are **tricks designed to fool you**. Attackers pretend to be trusted companies or colleagues. They use **fear (“your account will be locked”)** or **temptation (“you’ve won a prize”)** to make you click quickly. Once you do, they can steal your password, money, or install harmful software.

Think of phishing as a **digital con game** — the attacker’s goal is to make you act before you think.

Prevention Guidelines

- **Pause Before Clicking:** Hover over links to see the real destination.
- **Verify Requests:** Call or email the company directly using official contacts.
- **Don’t Share Passwords via Email:** Legitimate companies never ask this way.
- **Report Suspicious Emails:** Use your company’s “Report Phishing” button or forward to IT.
- **Update Software Regularly:** Prevent malware exploits.
- **Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA):** Adds a safety layer even if your password is stolen.
- **Train Employees Regularly:** Awareness campaigns reduce risk significantly.

Awareness Takeaway

Phishing is **not just a technical problem** — it’s a **human problem**. Attackers exploit trust, fear, and curiosity. By learning the warning signs and practicing safe email habits, users can avoid becoming victims. Even the biggest companies have fallen for phishing, so vigilance is essential.